Virgil, as “angry at the bridge,” since the Romans built a bridge over it, so that it is thereby conquered. The river Aras has been associated with the biblical rivers Gihon and Pishon (The Birthplace of Man, 1929).

Interestingly, we get to hear from sources that Aras had status of mother for the Armenian folks. Robert H. Hewsen described Aras as the only “true river” of Armenia and as “Mother Araxes,” a symbol of pride to the Armenian people (Robert H. Hewsen, 1997). According to Strabo, Araxes River in Armenia had no outflow to the Caspian Sea, and it spread out in plains creating a lake without outflow (Strabo).

The modern times saw Aras gaining a significant political boundary. As per the Treaty of Gulistan, and the Treaty of Turkmenchay, the river Aras was chosen as the border extent amid Russian Empire and Qajar Iran. Qajar Iran was forced to give away it’s Caucasian Territories to Russia.

Aras gained significance as a geographic political boundary. Under the terms of the Treaty of Gulistan (24 October of AD 1813) and the Treaty of Turkmenchay (21 February of AD1858), the river was chosen as the border limit between the Russian Empire and Qajar Iran, as the latter was forced to cede its Caucasian territories to Russia (Dowling, 2014). This nineteenth century change made Aras River as the line of continental demarcation between Europe and Asia. In the twentieth century USSR and Iran built the Aras Dam in the Poldasht area creating the Aras Reservoir.

7 Tumen, or tümen (‘unit of ten thousand’ (web.archive.org); Old Turkic: tümän; Mongolian: Түмэн, tumen (Hans-Peter Vietze, 1998); Turkish: tümen; Hungarian: tömény), was a part of the decimal system used by the Turkic and Mongol people to organize their tribal life and armies. Tumen is a social and military unit of 10,000 households and soldiers.

8 It was assumed that the same type of military organization was used by the Magyars during the conquest of Hungary. According to the Persian explorer and geographer, Ahmad ibn Rustah (AD 930), “Magyars are a race of Turks and their king rides out with horsemen to the number of 10,000 and this king is called Kanda” (Laszlo, 1996). He relied on the secondary sources and hence same cannot be confirmed with authority using this source. The reliable sources state that Magyars were linguistically Finno-Ugric-speaking peoples and did not speak Turkic. Modern scholarship finds that the Magyar/Hungarian cavalry units were called Bandeira and Dündar and not organized in units of 10,000 (Heath, 1984).

In Genghis Khān followed a military system wherein a tumen was recursively built from units of 10 (aravt), 100 (zuut) and 1,000 (mingghan), each with a leader reporting to the next higher level. Tumens were considered a practical size, neither too small for an effective campaign nor too big for efficient